SSC CHSL 2019 Tier-I question paper with answers

21 October 2020 · Shift 2

49 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 51 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20210126081103/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerkeyCHSL2019T1_22012021.pdf

English Language (Basic Knowledge) 24 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. The police used tear gas to _____ the crowd.

(A) disburse
(B) collect
(C) attack
(D) disperse

Q.2

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Take something with a pinch of salt

(A) To take long to understand what is being said
(B) To think of oneself as always right
(C) To consider everyone a liar
(D) To believe only part of something

Q.3

Select the word that means the same as the given group of words. A person weak and disabled by illness

(A) Activist
(B) Invalid
(C) Athlete
(D) Petitioner

Q.4

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Preamble
(B) Pnemonia
(C) Miscellaneous
(D) Deviation

Q.5

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. All her life Ms. Foster had a great fear of missing a train, a plane, a boat or (1)_____ a theatre curtain. In other respects, she was not a (2)_____ nervous woman. But the mere thought of (3)_____ on occasions like these would throw her (4)_____ such a nervous state that a tiny muscle in the corner of her left eye would (5)_____ twitch .This would disappear once she had boarded the plane etc.

Select the most appropriate option for blank No. 1.

(A) quite
(B) extremely
(C) even
(D) hardly

Q.6

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. All her life Ms. Foster had a great fear of missing a train, a plane, a boat or (1)_____ a theatre curtain. In other respects, she was not a (2)_____ nervous woman. But the mere thought of (3)_____ on occasions like these would throw her (4)_____ such a nervous state that a tiny muscle in the corner of her left eye would (5)_____ twitch .This would disappear once she had boarded the plane etc.

Select the most appropriate option for blank No. 2.

(A) usual
(B) general
(C) particular
(D) particularly

Q.7

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. All her life Ms. Foster had a great fear of missing a train, a plane, a boat or (1)_____ a theatre curtain. In other respects, she was not a (2)_____ nervous woman. But the mere thought of (3)_____ on occasions like these would throw her (4)_____ such a nervous state that a tiny muscle in the corner of her left eye would (5)_____ twitch .This would disappear once she had boarded the plane etc.

Select the most appropriate option for blank No. 3.

(A) be later
(B) being late
(C) be late
(D) being later

Q.8

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. All her life Ms. Foster had a great fear of missing a train, a plane, a boat or (1)_____ a theatre curtain. In other respects, she was not a (2)_____ nervous woman. But the mere thought of (3)_____ on occasions like these would throw her (4)_____ such a nervous state that a tiny muscle in the corner of her left eye would (5)_____ twitch .This would disappear once she had boarded the plane etc.

Select the most appropriate option for blank No. 4.

(A) into
(B) up
(C) away
(D) in

Q.9

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. All her life Ms. Foster had a great fear of missing a train, a plane, a boat or (1)_____ a theatre curtain. In other respects, she was not a (2)_____ nervous woman. But the mere thought of (3)_____ on occasions like these would throw her (4)_____ such a nervous state that a tiny muscle in the corner of her left eye would (5)_____ twitch .This would disappear once she had boarded the plane etc.

Select the most appropriate option for blank No. 5.

(A) begun over
(B) begun to
(C) begin to
(D) begin over

Q.11

In the sentence identify the segment which contains the grammatical error. Subhash Gidwani is selling dolls, which are type of Madhya Pradesh's village culture, at the Annual Dastakar Bazaar, held in January every year in Delhi.

(A) Subhash Gidwani is selling dolls
(B) in the annual Dastakar Bazaar
(C) held in January every year in Delhi
(D) which are type of Madhya Pradesh's village culture

Q.12

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Pick the option that gives their correct order. A. Finally, she takes the decision to go searching for livelihood in the nearby town. B. They are: Lakua and his wife, Nathuni. C. The latter, burdened with a paralytic husband and two children, battles to survive. D. The film 'Wayfarers' narrates the journey of a poor couple in Jharkhand.

(A) CDAB
(B) DBAC
(C) DBCA
(D) BACD

Q.13

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Pick the option that gives their correct order. A. The Emperor would view the comic acts from the jharokha, a special window of his palace. B. On the festival of Holi, the Emperor was entertained with mimicry, impersonation and play-acting. C. Bahadur Shah Jafar's life and times are described in a book called 'City of my heart.' D. Finally, the most talented of the performers would be generously awarded by the king.

(A) CBAD
(B) CDBA
(C) ADBC
(D) DACB

Q.14

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No improvement'. The Delhi Birla International School "alumnus occupy" leading positions in different areas of profession and service.

(A) alumnus occupies
(B) alumnus occupying
(C) No improvement
(D) alumni occupy

Q.15

Select the correct indirect form of given sentence. The foreigner said to the farmer, "Can you tell me the way to the nearest hotel?"

(A) The foreigner told the farmer if he could tell him the way to the nearest hotel.
(B) The foreigner suggested the farmer if he could tell him the way to the nearest hotel.
(C) The foreigner exclaimed with the farmer if he could tell him the way to the nearest hotel.
(D) The foreigner enquired of the farmer if he could tell him the way to the nearest hotel.

Q.16

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. CONGENIAL

(A) Compatible
(B) Servile
(C) Aloof
(D) Bombastic

Q.17

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. PACIFIST

(A) Orator
(B) Warmonger
(C) Nihilist
(D) Peace-maker

Q.18

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Full of sound and fury

(A) A fiery and effective speaker

(B) Someone who gets angry very quickly

(C) Merely loud and angry words but ineffective

(D) An angry and unruly mob

Q.19

In the sentence identify the segment which contains the grammatical error. You must make a choice immediately because there is few time left.

(A) because there is

(B) You must make

(C) few time left

(D) a choice immediately

Q.20

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. Ritu is an _____ reader. I always find her with a book.

(A) irritated

(B) erratic

(C) avid

(D) inattentive

Q.21

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. PEDIGREE

(A) Forbidden

(B) Illegitimate

(C) Mongrel

(D) Lineage

Q.22

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No improvement'. For the last two years Shweta "has being" diligently working with Rohingya refugees to create colourful table mats using their local weaving techniques.

(A) have been

(B) has been

(C) No improvement

(D) have being

Q.23

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. PROLIFIC

(A) Unproductive

(B) Rich

(C) Abundant

(D) Several

Q.24

Select the correct passive form of the given sentence. Chhattisgarh organised the first ever 'All India Folk Dance Festival' in January 2020.

(A) The first ever 'All India Folk Dance Festival' was organised by the Chhattisgarh State in January 2020.

(B) The first ever 'All India Folk Dance Festival' was being organised by the Chhattisgarh State in January 2020.

(C) The first ever 'All India Folk Dance Festival' will be organised by the Chhattisgarh State in January 2020.

(D) The first ever 'All India Folk Dance Festival' had been organised by the Chhattisgarh State in January 2020.

Q.25

Select the word that means the same as the given group of words. Happening every two years

(A) Centennial

(B) Biennial

(C) Biannual

(D) Triennial

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1
Which instrument is used to measure the level of humidity?

(A) Fathometer
(B) Galvanometer
(C) Hygrometer
(D) Hydrometer

Q.2
The first barcode system was developed by:

(A) Norman Joseph Woodland
(B) John Mc Carthy
(C) John Barger
(D) David Bradley

Q.3
Which of the following forms of martial arts is from Kerala?

(A) Paika Akhada
(B) Gatka
(C) Kalarippayattu
(D) Silambam

Q.4
How many Vedangas are there in total?

(A) Ten
(B) Six
(C) Five
(D) Two

Q.5
Which of the following characteristics of sound is measured in hertz (Hz)?

(A) Frequency of the sound
(B) Intensity of the sound
(C) Wavelength of the sound
(D) Loudness of the sound

Q.6
In which year did NITI Aayog come into existence?

(A) 2014
(B) 2013
(C) 2015
(D) 2016

Q.7
The term ‘monsoon’ is derived from a/an:

(A) Italian word
(B) Latin word
(C) Arabic word
(D) Greek word

Q.8
In which year did the first Elected Parliament with two houses come into being in India?

(A) 1952
(B) 1953
(C) 1954
(D) 1955

Q.9
Who is author of the book ‘The Judgement: Inside Story of the Emergency in India’?

(A) KM Munshi
(B) Indira Gandhi
(C) Kuldip Nayar
(D) Jawaharlal Nehru

Q.10
Who among the following is nicknamed the ‘Baltimore Bullet’?

(A) Tom Jager
(B) Ian Thorpe
(C) Matt Biondi
(D) Michael Phelps

Q.11
In January 2020, who among the following launched the first girder of the Mumbai Trans-Harbour Link (MTHL)?

(A) Raj Thackeray
(B) Uddhav Thackeray
(C) Aaditya Thackeray
(D) Bal Thackeray

Q.12
Who Inaugurated the National Tribal Festival "Aadi Mahotsav" in New Delhi in November 2019?

(A) Smriti Irani
(B) Amit Shah
(C) N. Sitharaman
(D) Narendra Modi

Q.13
Which country ranked first in the 2019 Human Development India Index?

(A) Ireland
(B) Germany
(C) Norway
(D) Switzerland

Q.14
Who won the International Hockey Federation's (FIH) Player of the Year award in 2019?

(A) Dhyan Chand
(B) Pargat Singh
(C) Dilip Tirkey
(D) Manpreet Singh

Q.15
The Hornbill Festival is celebrated in which state?

(A) Assam
(B) Meghalaya
(C) Nagaland
(D) Arunachal Pradesh

Q.16
Telangana became the 29th state of India in which year?

(A) 2015
(B) 2014
(C) 2016
(D) 2017

Q.17
Which of the following was invented by Walter Hunt?

(A) Ship
(B) Safety pin
(C) Scooter
(D) Safety lamp

Q.18
Who among the following was a leader from Allahabad (now Prayagraj) in the revolt against the British in 1857?

(A) Tatya Tope
(B) Maulvi Liaquat Ali
(C) Khan Bahadur Khan
(D) Rani Laxmi Bai

Q.19
The Bomdila Pass is located in which state?

(A) Nagaland
(B) Arunachal Pradesh
(C) Sikkim
(D) Himachal Pradesh

Q.20
Trackball is which of the following devices?

(A) Input device
(B) Touchpad
(C) Output device
(D) Barcode reader

Q.21
Which country is the 2019 ICC Cricket World Cup champion?

(A) England
(B) Pakistan
(C) India
(D) Australia

Q.22
The Tropic of Cancer does NOT pass through which of the following Indian states?

(A) Madhya Pradesh
(B) West Bengal
(C) Andhra Pradesh
(D) Gujarat

Q.23
Who among the following is one of the Deputy Operations Director of the Mars Orbiter Mission (MOM)?

(A) Moumita Dutta
(B) Nandini Harinath
(C) Seetha Somasundaram
(D) Minal Rohit

Q.24
Which of the following is the second largest artificial lake in Asia?

(A) Chilika Lake in Odisha
(B) Chandubi Lake in Assam
(C) Kolleru Lake in Andhra Pradesh
(D) Dhebar Lake in Rajasthan

Q.25
In October 2019, which of the following pairs of Indian cities was included by UNESCO in its network of 'Creative Cities' on the occasion of World Cities Day 2019?

(A) Pune & Hyderabad
(B) Jodhpur & Kolkata
(C) Hyderabad & Mumbai
(D) Delhi & Mumbai

Answer key

English Language (Basic Knowledge)

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(A)**
Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(C)**
Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(B)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(D)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

Explanations

English Language (Basic Knowledge)

Q.1 · Answer (D) disperse

To 'disperse' a crowd is to scatter it, which is what tear gas is used for. 'Disburse' means to pay out money.

Q.2 · Answer (D) To believe only part of something

To take something 'with a pinch of salt' is to believe only part of it, doubting that it is wholly true.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Invalid

An 'invalid' is a person made weak or disabled by illness or injury. An activist campaigns for a cause and a petitioner makes a formal request.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Pnemonia

The correct spelling is 'pneumonia', with a silent 'p' followed by 'eu'.

Q.5 · Answer (C) even

'Even' introduces the most surprising item in the list: besides a train, a plane or a boat, she feared missing a theatre curtain.

Q.6 · Answer (D) particularly

An adverb is needed before the adjective 'nervous': 'not a particularly nervous woman'.

Q.7 · Answer (B) being late

After the preposition 'of' a gerund is needed, and her fear is of arriving late: 'the mere thought of being late'.

Q.8 · Answer (A) into

To 'throw someone into' a state is to put them suddenly into it: 'throw her into such a nervous state'.

Q.9 · Answer (C) begin to

After the modal 'would' the plain verb follows, and 'begin' takes a to-infinitive: 'would begin to twitch'.

Q.11 · Answer (D) which are type of Madhya Pradesh’s village culture

'Type' is a singular countable noun and cannot stand without an article; the sense needed is 'which are typical of Madhya Pradesh's village culture'. The bazaar segment is correct whether read as the sentence prints it ('at the Annual Dastakar Bazaar') or as its option does ('in the annual ...').

Q.12 · Answer (C) DBCA

D introduces the film and the poor couple, B names them, C turns to 'the latter', Nathuni, and her struggle, and A, beginning 'Finally', gives her decision: DBCA.

Q.13 · Answer (A) CBAD

C introduces the book on the Emperor's life and times, B describes the Holi entertainment, A how the Emperor watched 'the comic acts', and D, beginning 'Finally', the rewards: CBAD.

Q.14 · Answer (D) alumni occupy

SSC's key gives 'alumni occupy': leading positions in different areas of profession and service point to many former pupils, so the plural 'alumni' (singular 'alumnus') takes the plural verb 'occupy'. 'Alumnus occupies' is also grammatical, but it would have one person holding positions across many fields.

Q.15 · Answer (D) The foreigner enquired of the farmer if he could tell him the way to the nearest hotel.

A question is reported with a verb of asking, such as 'enquired of', followed by 'if'; 'told', 'suggested' and 'exclaimed with' do not report a question.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Compatible

'Congenial' means pleasant to be with because of shared interests or character: 'compatible'. 'Servile' means too eager to please, 'aloof' distant and 'bombastic' pompous in speech.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Warmonger

A 'pacifist' opposes war and violence; a 'warmonger' seeks to stir up war. A 'nihilist' rejects all moral principles.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Merely loud and angry words but ineffective
'Full of sound and fury', from Shakespeare's 'Macbeth', describes loud, angry talk that means or achieves nothing.

Q.19 · Answer (C) few time left
'Few' goes with plural countable nouns; 'time' is uncountable, so it takes 'little': 'there is little time left'.

Q.20 · Answer (C) avid
An 'avid' reader is a keen and eager one, which fits someone always found with a book. 'Erratic' and 'inattentive' suggest the opposite.

Q.21 · Answer (D) Lineage
'Pedigree' means a line of descent or ancestry: 'lineage'. A 'mongrel' is a dog of mixed breed, the opposite of a pedigree animal.

Q.22 · Answer (B) has been
The present perfect continuous is 'has been' with the '-ing' form: 'Shweta has been diligently working'. 'Have' does not go with the singular subject.

Q.23 · Answer (A) Unproductive
'Prolific' means producing much, so its opposite is 'unproductive'. 'Rich' and 'abundant' are close to it in meaning.

Q.24 · Answer (A) The first ever ‘All India Folk Dance Festival’ was organised by the Chhattisgarh State in January 2020.
The simple past 'organised' becomes 'was organised' in the passive; the other options change the tense.

Q.25 · Answer (B) Biennial
'Biennial' means happening every two years; 'biannual' means twice a year, 'triennial' every three years and 'centennial' every hundred years.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) Hygrometer
A hygrometer measures the humidity of the air. A hydrometer measures the density of liquids, a fathometer the depth of water and a galvanometer small electric currents.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Norman Joseph Woodland
Norman Joseph Woodland and Bernard Silver invented the barcode; their patent, which described codes of straight lines and of concentric circles, was granted in 1952. John McCarthy coined the term 'artificial intelligence'.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Kalarippayattu
Kalarippayattu is the martial art of Kerala. Paika Akhada is from Odisha, Gatka from Punjab and Silambam from Tamil Nadu.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Six
There are six Vedangas, the auxiliary studies of the Vedas: Shiksha (phonetics), Kalpa (ritual), Vyakarana (grammar), Nirukta (etymology), Chhanda (metre) and Jyotisha (astronomy).

Q.5 · Answer (A) Frequency of the sound
The hertz, one vibration a second, is the unit of frequency. Loudness is expressed in decibels and wavelength in metres.

Q.6 · Answer (C) 2015
NITI Aayog replaced the Planning Commission on 1 January 2015.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Arabic word
'Monsoon' comes from the Arabic 'mausim', meaning season, after the seasonal reversal of the winds.

Q.8 · Answer (A) 1952
After the first general elections of 1951-52, the first elected Parliament, with the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha, came into being in 1952.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Kuldip Nayar
'The Judgement: Inside Story of the Emergency in India' (1977) is by the journalist Kuldip Nayar, who was detained during the Emergency.

Q.10 · Answer (D) Michael Phelps
The swimmer Michael Phelps, born in Baltimore, is nicknamed the 'Baltimore Bullet'.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Uddhav Thackeray
Uddhav Thackeray, then Chief Minister of Maharashtra, launched the first girder of the Mumbai Trans-Harbour Link at the Sewri end on 15 January 2020.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Amit Shah
Home Minister Amit Shah inaugurated Aadi Mahotsav, the national tribal festival of the Ministry of Tribal Affairs and TRIFED, at Dilli Haat, INA, on 16 November 2019.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Norway
Norway topped the Human Development Index in UNDP's Human Development Report 2019, released in December 2019, ahead of Switzerland and Ireland.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Manpreet Singh
India's hockey captain Manpreet Singh was named FIH Player of the Year for 2019, the first Indian to win the award.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Nagaland
The Hornbill Festival, a showcase of the cultures of the Naga tribes, is held every December in Nagaland, at Kisama near Kohima.

Q.16 · Answer (B) 2014
Telangana was formed from Andhra Pradesh on 2 June 2014, becoming India's 29th state.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Safety pin
The American inventor Walter Hunt patented the safety pin in 1849. The miners' safety lamp is Humphry Davy's.

Q.18 · Answer (B) Maulvi Liaquat Ali
Maulvi Liaquat Ali led the revolt of 1857 at Allahabad. Tatya Tope fought at Kanpur, Khan Bahadur Khan led at Bareilly and Rani Laxmi Bai at Jhansi.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Arunachal Pradesh
The Bomdila Pass is in the West Kameng district of Arunachal Pradesh.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Input device
A trackball is a pointing device, a ball rolled by the fingers to move the cursor, so it is an input device.

Q.21 · Answer (A) England
England won the 2019 ICC Cricket World Cup, beating New Zealand at Lord's on the boundary count after the final and its super over were tied.

Q.22 · Answer (C) Andhra Pradesh
The Tropic of Cancer crosses Gujarat, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, West Bengal, Tripura and Mizoram; Andhra Pradesh lies wholly south of it.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Nandini Harinath
Nandini Harinath of ISRO was one of the Deputy Operations Directors of the Mars Orbiter Mission, launched in November 2013.

Q.24 · Answer (D) Dhebar Lake in Rajasthan

Dhebar (Jaisamand) Lake near Udaipur, Rajasthan, formed by the dam Maharana Jai Singh built across the Gomati river in the late 17th century, is the lake usually cited as Asia's second-largest artificial lake. Chilika, Chandubi and Kolleru are natural lakes.

Q.25 · Answer (C) Hyderabad & Mumbai

On World Cities Day, 31 October 2019, UNESCO added Mumbai (film) and Hyderabad (gastronomy) to its Creative Cities Network.

This paper online, with tap-to-reveal answers: https://parikshasaathi.com/exams/ssc-chsl/question-papers/chsl-2019-tier-i-21-oct-2020-shift-2/
Every solved SSC CHSL paper: https://parikshasaathi.com/exams/ssc-chsl/question-papers/
Daily current affairs PDF, free, every morning on Telegram: t.me/parikshasaathiapp
Questions and official answers: the Staff Selection Commission (SSC). Explanations: drafted with AI assistance by Pariksha Saathi and checked against the official answers. Pariksha Saathi is not affiliated with any exam body. Spotted an error? Write to sriwastava2@gmail.com.